

A good discussion is interactive, and everybody gets a chance to speak. It is a conversation between people that are open to different views on the discussed topic and who present their point of view in a respectful way.

Tips for successful moderation of class discussion

- Introduce yourself briefly before the discussion.
- You may want to “teach” the class some difficult words of your topic (for example, display a short list of about 10 key words at the beginning of the discussion and go through them with class (e.g. elicit meaning)
- Start with a powerful opening and finish with a memorable ending.
- Visual back-up: Make sure to have some visual back-up with the structure of the discussion, so we can follow the process better.
- Be neutral – give the audience a chance to express their own views.
- Engage the audience throughout the debate and make sure everybody does this in a respectful way.
- Give the word to different people and don't be afraid to cut long monologues off!
- At the end make sure to reach and summarize briefly the outcome of the discussion.
- Most important: plan well, practice in advance and manage time effectively!

Main goal: many people in class will speak and say their opinion on your topic.

Useful expressions for a lively and respectful discussion in class

- Can I just come in here?
- Do we all agree?
- Have we reached an agreement on this?
- How do you feel about that idea?
- I agree./ I disagree.
- I see your point, but ...
- I suggest we move on to the next item on the agenda.
- I think...
- I'd go along with you there.
- I'd like to suggest that we should ...
- I'm sorry, but I just can't agree with you there.
- It seems to me that ...
- Let's move on.
- Sorry, but I don't quite follow you.
- Sorry, but ...
- Sorry, I don't understand.
- What do you think?
- Why don't we...?
- Would you mind telling us a little more about ...?
- Yes, but ...